Melanie Paulina Pizano

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EDUCATION

B.S. Statistics and Data Science (Minors in Digital Humanities & Global Health)

University of California, Los Angeles | Sep 2024 - Jun 2027 (Expected)

- GPA: 3.9 | Dean's Honors List (5x) | Mellon Data Justice Scholar

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Biokind Analytics at UCLA

Co-Head of Project Management (Jun 2026 - Present)

- Steered strategic vision and cross-functional alignment across 2 teams of 10 people, setting project milestones, evaluating team deliverables, and driving high-performance output through ongoing feedback and guidance.
- Directed and mentored 2 Project Leads, overseeing end-to-end project execution, optimizing team workflows, and accelerating professional development for 4+ non-profit healthcare organizations.

Project Lead | Data Analyst (Oct 2025 - Jun 2026)

- Led a team of 12 data analysts collaborating with 2 healthcare organizations (World Telehealth Initiative, Tichenor Clinic) to clean, transform, and analyze 2,000+ healthcare records, delivering 3 Tableau graphs, 4 Tableau maps, 4 wordclouds, 4 Excel Pivot tables, and 15 custom visualizations to drive executive reporting.
- Managed end-to-end project workflows by delegating technical tasks and conducting 40+ code reviews in R and Python, ensuring 100% data integrity and establishing high coding standards across all deliverables.

UCLA Statistics Department

Learning Assistant - Programming with R (Jan 2026 - Mar 2026)

- Facilitated active data science instruction for 80+ undergraduate students, leading weekly discussion sections, hosting office hours, and troubleshooting R programming debugging workflows.
- Partnered with the instructional team to optimize curriculum delivery, refine peer-learning frameworks, and provide targeted technical feedback to improve student code retention.

TECHNICAL PROJECTS

Amazon Consumer Behavior and Household Size Prediction | *R, Tidyverse, XGBoost, Random Forest, GAM*

- Preprocessed and merged 2,000+ transactional and survey records, constructing 50+ behavioral, seasonal, and life-stage metrics across retail product categories.
- Executed 10-fold cross-validation across 7 candidate models; tuned hyperparameter configurations for a Random Forest classifier to resolve non-linear feature interactions and high-cardinality variance.

Gender-Coded Language Analysis | *Python, NLTK, Scikit-learn*

- Scraped and processed 2,000+ job postings from LinkedIn and Indeed by engineering an end-to-end Python NLP pipeline to perform text mining, cleaning, and tokenization across STEM and Humanities fields.
- Cross-referenced text data against an established gender-coded wordbank to calculate linguistic density patterns and evaluate algorithmic bias in automated hiring inputs.

UCLA Residential Indoor Air Quality Analysis | *Tableau, Data Pipelines, Survey Design*

- Designed and deployed a multi-view interactive Tableau dashboard to visualize and analyze survey responses from 50+ students evaluating UCLA residential indoor air quality.
- Built automated data pipelines connected live survey inputs to enable real-time tracking, trend analysis, and spatial hotspot mapping to empower student advocacy groups with localized data.

American Statistical Association DataFest Competition UCLA| *Data Wrangling, Exploratory Data Analysis*

- Collaborated within a multidisciplinary team of 4 data analysts to clean, wrangle, and model a 5 Million+ record healthcare dataset under a strict 48-hour analytics hackathon deadline.
- Served as the Data Engineer and Project Manager, transforming the dataset for exploratory data analysis (EDA) and creating 5 statistical visualizations to present actionable findings to industry judges.

SKILLS

- **Languages:** Python, R, SQL, C++, Spanish (Intermediate)
- **Modeling:** Regression Analysis, XGBoost, Random Forest, Generalized Additive Models, Scikit-learn, NLTK, NLP
- **Data Methods:** Feature Engineering, Hyperparameter Tuning, Cross Validation, Data Preprocessing, Web Scraping, EDA
- **Visualization Tools:** Tableau, Excel(Pivot Tables), GitHub, Figma, OpenRefine, Palladio, WordPress